Unit -2

Political Parties



Learning Objectives

- To define what political party is and to understand the importance of the political party
- To know the role and function of a political party
- To understand the party system in India and the role of opposition party

Student Siva : Good morning Mam. May I come in?

Teacher Ms.Aadhi: Good morning Siva. Always you will be on time. Why are you so late today?

Siva: Sorry mam. I was delayed due to a procession.

Ms. Aadhi: What is it about? Who arranged this procession?

Siva : My uncle said "That is the work of the political party".

Ms. Aadhi: Oh. I see!

Siva : What is political party mam? Why are they doing so?

Ms. Aadhi: Wait. Today I am going to teach about political parties. Let us know all about that.

In earlier times, emperors and kings ruled India. The king was the supreme head of the Legislative, Executive and Judiciary branches. Governance was in the hands of one person. The welfare of the people depended on the ruler. People had no rights to do against the ruler. Later foreign powers made India as their colonies. The colonies became states after Independence was declared.

In 1950, India became a democratic country. A vibrant democracy needs a strong political party system. Party System is a modern phenomenon. In a democracy, people are able to voice their opinions on any subject.

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